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Chapter 3

Machine Manager Overview



Introduction

The Machine Manager module performs tasks which fall into two broad categories:

1 Housekeeping tasks

These are normally performed when all or most of the interactive users have finished with the system, and gone home. Tasks which fall into this category might include the re-organisation of database files, the securing of the off-line storage of the system's programs and data, or the production of some lengthy reports which might, for example, be scheduled to run on a weekly basis.

The time at which these overnight activities are initiated is decided by the user. At any time this value may be modified permanently or altered merely for the current night's trigger time.

Jobs scheduled for overnight execution may be set up and 'masked' to run on any night (or each night) of the week, or to run on specific dates. The 'mask' may be temporarily overridden for a particular night. The facility to schedule the date on which a job runs is also available. For example, you may wish to run a task or set of tasks on the 10th of each month.

After the completion of all tasks which have been scheduled for overnight running, the machine if required will power itself off. This process is perfectly normal and is recommended for the IBM AS/400. On successfully re-starting (IPL) the system will run through a list of tasks which may be similarly scheduled to general use. The re-starting of the IBM AS/400 is fully automated and unattended, the machine is therefore ready for the users when they arrive on the following day.

2 Scheduled tasks

These are those jobs you wish to perform during the normal working day and require their initiation to be scheduled for a specified time. Tasks which fall into this category might include sending a message to a user(s) to remind them a meeting is about to start, the production of a report or initiating an update program during an inactive period, maybe the lunch break.

In addition to the control of the initiation of tasks Machine Manager provides a fast and user friendly method of setting up standard tasks. For example, a task from the Inventory Management application, or a task from the Housekeeping module such as compressing libraries, to be run as part of your day-end routines.

To access Machine Manager enter 6 in the option field and press **Enter**, or use the Roll keys to move the 'action bar' so that Machine Manager is highlighted and press **Enter**.

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Machine Manager

System: STUDB30A

Main Menu

1. Auto Day-Start Jobs

2. Auto Day-End Jobs

3. Job Schedules

4. End Day Times

5. Power Down Times

6. Job Schedule Times

7. Group Schedules

8. Protected Queues

9. Operational Enquiries

10. Exit

Selection or command
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F3=Exit

F4=Prompt

F6=Messages

F9=Retrieve

F10=Command Entry

F12=Previous

F14=View Jobs

F24=More Keys